

**FOURSQUARE GOSPEL CHURCH
BARUWA DISTRICT HEADQUARTERS ABESAN GATE
BIBLE STUDY: YOUTH WEEK 2023 - A PERFECT HEART**

DATE: WEDNESDAY, 25TH APRIL, 2023.

THEME: A PERFECT HEART

TEXT: 1CHRONICLES 28: 9

INTRODUCTION

DEFINITION:

What is a Perfect Heart?

A perfect heart is obedient to God without hesitation or compromise.

A perfect heart loves God with every fibre of its being and shuns the lure of earthly treasure. It stakes its very life on the promise of God's faithfulness.

A perfect heart is unadulterated in its humility before the Lord.

- It doesn't mean that we are perfect people who never make mistakes. It means that we have a heart that is set on pleasing God and doing His will. It means that we are striving to live a life that is pleasing to Him, and we are doing our best to follow His commandments. - **1 Kings 8:61 and Psalm 101:2.**
- In the Kingdom, a perfect heart is not gotten by your own strength, it is given to you by God. - **Ezekiel 11:19 Psalm 103:8-14 and Ephesians 2:8-9**

Let us consider the following outlines:

- 1. RECEIVING A PERFECT HEART**
- 2. HINDRANCES TO HAVING A PERFECT HEART**
- 3. MAINTAINING AND PURSUING A PERFECT HEART**

1.RECEIVING A PERFECT HEART

The Bible says in **Philippians 2: 13** '*For it is God who works in you both to will and to work, for his good pleasure*' ... this means that we cannot please God unless he makes us please him, unless he works in us and through us.

Hebrews 4; 12 ... Come boldly unto the throne of grace to obtain mercy and help....

Malachi 4:6...It is only God's mercy that can give us a heart to please him.

STEPS TO RECEIVING A PERFECT HEART

- We are willing to confess our sins and ask for forgiveness – **1John 1:9, Proverbs 28:19**
- Come boldly but come humbly – **Isaiah 57:15, James 4:6**

2. HINDRANCES TO HAVING A PERFECT HEART

The adversary (the devil) is the major hindrance to having a perfect heart, he desires to take away the heart of men from the way of perfection.- **John 10:10, 1Peter 5:8**

The following ways are the actions that the devil uses to draw away our heart from perfection:

- Cares of the world - **Luke 8:14, Luke 21:34**
- Sin - **James 4:8**
- Works of the flesh **Galatians 5:19**

3. MAINTAINING AND PURSUING A PERFECT HEART

Living a perfect life before God requires a conscious and deliberate effort.

We need to maintain the following attributes and characters in order to live perfectly before God:

- Guard your heart (***Proverbs 4:23***) ; As youths we are exposed to all sort of vile and negative things in the world; let us guard our heart
- Maintain a life of prayer and devotion - ***1King 9:3***
- Stay under the umbrella of a local church - ***Proverbs 27: 17***
- Have a spiritual mentor/ covering. - ***Proverbs 22:28, Proverbs 1:8***

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, having a perfect heart is not about being perfect, but rather about striving to live a life that is pleasing to God. We must guard our hearts against anything that would lead us away from Him, and fill our hearts with love, joy, and kindness. And when we fall short, we must be willing to confess our sins and ask for forgiveness. May we all strive to have a perfect heart and live a life that brings glory to God. Amen.